Bridging Continents through Partnership, Creating Lasting Opportunities for Growth and Prosperity.





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Foreword

Africa's Atlantic gateway is being reshaped, and Senegal stands at the forefront of this transformation.By combining responsible resource development with economic diversification, institutional reforms, innovation, and infrastructure development, Senegal is laying the foundation for long-term, inclusive, and resilient growth. For India, this presents an opportunity to deepen engagement with a trusted partner that is increasingly significant within the African continent.

The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India (CCI India) has consistently believed that India's partnership with Africa should extend beyond traditional markets and embrace emerging economies that offer long-term strategic value. Senegal's strategic geographic location, its strong regional connectivity, and its role as a gateway to Francophone West Africa make it an attractive destination for Indian businesses seeking to expand their presence across the region. Supported by a stable policy environment, growing investment opportunities, and an outward-looking economic vision, Senegal provides an ideal platform for strengthening bilateral trade, investment, technology collaboration, and industrial partnerships.

This Knowledge Paper has been prepared to serve as a comprehensive and reliable reference for policymakers, diplomats, business leaders, investors, and institutions interested in understanding Senegal's economic landscape and the expanding scope of India–Senegal cooperation. It provides an overview of the country's development priorities, key economic sectors, investment ecosystem, policy framework, and areas where the two nations can build stronger commercial and institutional partnerships. The report also explores emerging opportunities across sectors such as agriculture, healthcare, renewable energy, infrastructure, manufacturing, digital technologies, education, logistics, mining, tourism, and the evolving energy landscape.

Beyond identifying opportunities, this publication seeks to promote meaningful dialogue and practical collaboration between stakeholders in both countries. It highlights the role that CCI India can play in facilitating business engagement, fostering investment partnerships, supporting knowledge exchange, encouraging innovation, and creating stronger institutional linkages between the public and private sectors. Through sustained engagement and collaborative initiatives, CCI India remains committed to serving as a bridge that brings together businesses, entrepreneurs, investors, and policymakers from India and Senegal.



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SENEGAL

> Experience vibrant culture and rhythm, where music and tradition thrive.



Introduction

The Republic of Senegal is a West African coastal nation known for its political stability, strong institutions, dynamic culture, and strategic Atlantic port in Dakar. It serves as an economic gateway to the West African region and maintains active partnerships with Europe,Asias, and Africa.

Senegal has a diversified economy supported by services, agriculture, fisheries, mining, and a growing energy sector following offshore oil and gas discoveries. It also maintains a resident embassy in New Delhi, enabling direct diplomatic and economic cooperation with India.

Basic Facts & Demographics

Senegal is a semi-presidential republic with its capital in Dakar, a major economic and maritime hub.

- **Population:** approx. 18.5–19 million (2024–25 estimates)
- **Language:** French (official), with widely spoken national languages such as Wolof, Pulaar and Serer
- **Currency:** West African CFA Franc (XOF)
- **Geography:** Located along the Atlantic, Senegal has a strong trading position due to its port infrastructure and proximity to European and American shipping routes

Economy — GDP, Structure & Recent Performance

Senegal is considered one of West Africa's more resilient economies.

- GDP (Nominal): approx. US$ 34–35 billion (2025, following a 2025 GDP rebasing exercise)
- Growth Rate: accelerated sharply to approx. 7–8% in 2024–2025, driven by the start of offshore oil and gas production, with growth expected to moderate to around 4–5% from 2026 onward as initial production effects normalize

Major economic drivers include:

- Services: finance, telecoms, tourism, transport
- Agriculture: groundnuts, horticulture, livestock
- Fisheries: one of the most important sectors for export income and employment

Senegal is recognized for its economic reforms under the Plan Sénégal Émergent (PSE), which focuses on industrialization, infrastructure development and investment promotion.

Culture and Heritage

The culture and heritage of Senegal are vibrant and deeply rooted in tradition, shaped by diverse ethnic groups such as the Wolof, Serer, and Fulani. Music and dance play a central role in Senegalese life, with styles like mbalax reflecting the country's rich artistic expression. Strong community values, respect for elders, and the concept of teranga (hospitality) define social interactions. Islam is the dominant religion and greatly influences customs and daily life. Historic sites like Gorée Island stand as powerful reminders of the country's past, particularly its role in the transatlantic slave trade.

Bilateral Trade Between India & Senegal

India and Senegal maintain strong and growing trade relations, with bilateral trade generally ranging between $ 1.2–1.5 billion annually depending on commodity cycles.

India's Exports to Senegal:

- Rice & cereals (largest export category)
- Cotton & textiles
- Pharmaceuticals
- Machinery & engineering goods
- Meat & edible products
- Electrical & electronic equipment
- Automotive components & vehicles
- Chemicals & plastics

Senegal's Exports to India:

- Phosphates & fertilizer inputs
- Cashew & agro commodities
- Seafood
- Scrap and mineral resources

India is a key importer of phosphoric acid and phosphate rock from Senegal, which are critical inputs for its fertilizer industry. In return, India is among Senegal's key suppliers of essential goods, food items, medicines and engineering products.

Economic & Strategic Areas Of Cooperation

- **Agriculture & Agri-processing:**
  India supports Senegal in seeds, irrigation, farm mechanization and agri-processing technology.
- **Fertilizers & Minerals:**
  Senegal's phosphate industry is a backbone of bilateral trade; Indian fertilizer companies maintain partnerships with Senegalese producers.
- **Energy & Renewables:**
  India's expertise in Solar Energy provides opportunities for collaboration, particularly in rural electrification.
- **ICT & Digital Services:**
  Senegal has a strong ICT ecosystem, offering room for cooperation in e-governance, fintech and training.



Opportunities & Risks in Senegal

Opportunities:

- Growing demand for affordable medicines, making India a preferred supplier Expanding market for
- automotive parts, engineering goods, and solar equipment
- High potential in fertilizer partnerships, mining supply chains, and petrochemicals
- Strong scope for Indian investment in agri-processing and seafood value chains

Risks:

- Bureaucratic delays in approvals and public procurement
- Port congestion and shipping delays during peak periods
- Currency fluctuations in the CFA zone
- Competition from European and Chinese exporters
- Occasional regional political tensions, although Senegal remains one of West Africa's more stable countries

Chapter 1: About Senegal

Geography and Strategic Location

The Republic of Senegal occupies the westernmost point of the African continent, bordered by Mauritania to the north, Mali to the east, Guinea and Guinea-Bissau to the south, and the Atlantic Ocean to the west, with The Gambia forming a narrow enclave within Senegalese territory along the Gambia River. Covering approximately 196,700 square kilometres, Senegal's coastline stretches for more than 700 kilometres, anchoring the deep-water Port of Dakar, one of the busiest and best-connected ports on the West African seaboard. Senegal's location roughly five hours by air from Europe, seven from the Americas, and nine from the Middle East and southern Africa has long made it a natural transshipment and logistics hub for trade flows between Europe, the Americas, and West and Central Africa.

Demographics

Senegal's population stood at approximately 18.4 million as of the most recent census-based estimates, with the World Bank and IMF projecting continued growth toward 19–20 million by the late 2020s. The population is notably young, with a median age below 19 years and roughly 60 per cent of Senegalese under the age of 25 a demographic profile that presents both a long-term growth dividend and an immediate youth-employment challenge. Dakar, the capital and primary economic centre, is home to over 3 million people in its metropolitan area; other major urban centres include Touba (the country's second-largest city and spiritual seat of the Mouride Sufi order), Thiès, Rufisque, Kaolack, and Saint-Louis, the historic former colonial capital.

Political System and Administrative Structure

Senegal is a unitary semi-presidential republic and is widely regarded as one of the most stable, uninterrupted multi-party democracies in Africa, having avoided the military coups that have affected several neighbouring states. The President is elected by direct universal suffrage for a five-year term, renewable once, and serves as head of state; a Prime Minister, appointed by the President, heads the government. Following the March 2024 presidential election, Mr. Bassirou Diomaye Diakhar Faye was elected as Senegal's fifth president, with Mr. Ousmane Sonko serving as Prime Minister. The country's legislature is unicameral, comprising the National Assembly. Administratively, Senegal is divided into 14 régions, further subdivided into départements, arrondissements, and communes, providing a structured framework for decentralised governance and local economic planning.

Capital, Currency, and Language

Attribute	Detail
Capital	Dakar
Official Language	French
National Languages	Wolof (widely spoken as lingua franca), Pulaar, Serer, Diola, Mandinka, and others
Currency	West African CFA Franc (XOF), pegged to the Euro at a fixed rate of €1 = XOF 655.957

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